"The Greatest Expedition you will ever undertake is the journey to self-understanding, for the real voyage of discovery consists not in seeking new lands, but in seeing with new eyes."

DANIEL J COMP

AN INTERACTIVE - AI GUIDED - SELF-MASTERY EXPEDITION FOR LEAVING

SCOTOMAVILLE



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Filmed on location (tour map):
Pacific Northwest: Bellingham, WA; Semiahmoo, Blaine, WA; Stanwood, WA; Maryhill Memorial, WA; White Pass WA; Chelan WA; Plymouth WA; Mount Hood Meadows, OR; White River Snow Park, Mt. Hood, OR; Hood River, OR; Bend, OR; Three Mile Canyon, OR; **California, Nevada:** BLM, Susanville, CA; Oroville, CA; Washoe Lake, NV; Rye Patch, NV; Pine Flat Lake, CA; Lake Cahuilla La Quinta, CA; Barstow, CA; French Camp, Tom's Place, CA; **Idaho, Montana, Wyoming**: Coeur d'Alene, ID; Twin Falls ID; Murtough Lake, ID; 3 Island Crossing, ID; Scotch Pines GC, ID; Rigby, ID; Missoula MT; Billings, MT; Clark Canyon Res, MT; Rocky Point, Belle Fourche, MT; Casper WY; **Utah, Colorado, New Mexico, Arizona:** Piute Reservoir, UT; Jordanelle Reservoir, UT; Bald Mountain, UT; Bonneville Salt Flats, UT; Little Salt Lake UT; Sand Hollow, Hurricane, UT; Purgatory Resort, CO; Longmont, CO; Chatfield State Park, Littleton, CO; Grand Junction, CO; Albuquerque, NM; Bottomless Lakes, Roswell, NM; Caballo Lake, NM; Elephant Butte, NM; VLA Radio Observatory, NM; Lake Pleasant, AZ; Homolovi Ruins, AZ; Scottsdale, AZ; BLM, Tusayan AZ; BLM, Quartzsite, AZ; Potato Patch CG, Jerome, AZ; Porter Spring, Roosevelt, AZ; Apache Gold, San Carlos, AZ; Roper Lake State Park, AZ; Fool Hollow, Show Low, AZ; **Kansas, Nebraska, South Dakota:**; Wichita KS; Lake Kanopolis, KS; Wilson Lake, KS; Lewis & Clark Rec Area, Yankton, SD; Platte Creek Rec Area, SD; Badlands National Park, SD; Lake Mcconaughy NE; **Oklahoma, Texas:** Oklahoma City, OK; Bear Creek Cove, OK; Lake Texoma, OK/TX; Tulsa, OK; Lawton, OK; Wichita Falls, TX; Lake Lavon, TX; Littlefield, TX; Van Horn, TX; Palmetto S.P., TX; League City, TX; Yegua Creek, Somerville, TX; Waco, TX; Lake Whitney, TX; Canyon Lake, TX; Clear Lake, Princeton, TX; Cedar Hill State Park, TX;

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*The desire to understand ourselves, to unravel the mystery of **WIDWID**—Why I Do What I Do—connects us all. It's a question I have pursued by cycling across America on three inspiring Journeys with a Purpose.*

*After decades of mishaps and 50,000 miles dragging an Airstream I no longer view **Know Thyself** as a luxury or a full-out competition with AI. With a team of like-minded thinkers (a self-defined minyan) empowered by a super-reasoning engine, I am becoming a thought leader and a sage celebrating the later execution phases of my Personal Everest with the help of a digital Sherpa.*

***Remember your first journey?** I was hopeful yet unprepared, like a Fiat 500 strapped with a useless burden on my back. At first, this image represented my idealistic youthful exploration, a journey both underpowered and naive. Recently, I discovered a double meaning in the word 'Fiat' itself. Beyond the name of a car, it refers to a decree, an authoritative commandment. In my journey, these were the self-imposed life commandments from false conclusions I formed of misspoken judgments that had shaped my worldview. It was as if the very mascot of my exploration challenged me to escape the self-tyranny of my thinking. W.H. Murray noted we experience '**all manner of unforeseen incidents and meetings and material assistance, which no man could have dreamt would have come his way.**' The discovery of the Fiat's symbolic richness was one such unforeseen incident that deepened my journey.*

Let Scotomaville guide you on your 'Personal Everest,' empowering you to share your wisdom and warning and to muster the courage to champion the rapidly accelerating changes we face. Join me by turning the life you inherited into the outcomes you design.

April 27, 2024



AUTHORS + ABSTRACT



AUTHORS CURATORS

Daniel believes; ***"The Greatest Expedition you will ever undertake is the journey to self-understanding, for the real voyage of discovery consists not in seeking new lands, but in seeing with new eyes."*** *He is a respected husband, father, entrepreneur, and Navy Veteran. He's demonstrated decades of sacrificial commitment to human achievement using core principles, perseverance, and resourcefulness.*

Angelina is the wife of a highly functioning Asperger (me) and co-founder with me of Intelligent Netware. She is twice awarded by the U.S. S.B.A. In 2004, she sustained a TBI five days before filming for the Apprentice III. Angelina is the Founder of Wellness by Choice and a mom with a mission - bent on educating and empowering the masses on how to live smarter and healthier.

SCOTOMAVILLE ABSTRACT

- ***BACKGROUND - WWDWWD***

Most people respond to chaos and stress with coping mechanisms, amygdala hijackings, and reactive behavior. For some of us, curiosity dominates. We want to know ***"Why We Do What We Do."*** *and are committed to exploring the unknown... to 'Know Thyself'. The Author cycled across America three times asking this.*

The pandemic has challenged us with hardships, losses, setbacks, missed opportunities, and personal drama. [1] Americans are weary of rapidly accelerating change.

We are flooded with messaging that games our biological and psychological bents [2]. Emotions easily overwhelm our reasoning to control our actions. We're further conflicted by being 100% wrong 50% of the time. [3] [4]

We're hoodwinked and bamboozled by tech, media, and popular narratives using trickery, flattery, and omission. [5] The adage to 'Know Thyself' is no longer a luxury. It's become a full-out competition with supercomputers pointed at our brains. [6]

■ *METHODS - IMPARTATION*

The Scotomaville program deploys the unique IMPARTATION METHODOLOGY, designed to guide participants in self-reflection and personal growth through video modeling. This methodology unfolds in a structured manner:

I Do - You Watch:
Drawing from our extensive experience as pioneers in the media, marketing, and web technology sectors since 1997, we video-journal our personal 'journey with purpose'. Through these recordings, we share and demonstrate 15 invaluable mental tools, tests, and insights that enable resilience in facing challenges. Participants, armed with just a smartphone, can emulate our perseverance as we navigate adversities such as Traumatic Brain Injury, PTSD, and more.

We Do - We Watch:
The program is more than just watching; it's engaging. Fifty-three episodes are complemented by a comprehensive 400+ page guide, enriched with opportunities for online discussions. Subscribers benefit from peer support, mentoring, and personalized guidance. Furthermore, the extensive digital reach, spanning over 4500 affiliated websites, allows for participant and sponsor recognition.

You Do - I Watch:
The Scotomaville journey doesn't end with passive learning. Upcoming offerings include transformative base camp summits, private retreats, and expeditions for leaders. With the program's licensed platform, certified leaders can guide individuals and groups, encouraging them to tread the transformative path we demonstrate.

■ *FINDINGS - SELF-GAMING*

By climbing a 'Personal Everest' and testing for oneself, the claims of W.H. Murray, and the Authors that Expeditions are filled with ***"unforeseen incidents and meetings and material assistance, which no one could have dreamt would have come their way"*** *(9) you can develop clarity, stability, healing, and successes by gaming your biases.*

Self-mastery begins with awareness of one's physical and mental self. When combined with understanding, support, and discipline, incremental character change transforms one's beliefs, attitudes, and behavior.

SCOTOMAVILLE reveals the intricate interdependence between our gut and brain, demonstrating how sleep patterns and stress levels influence our choices. By emphasizing the perils of tackling challenges solo and showcasing actionable insights and examples, the program empowers individuals to recognize and navigate their inherent cognitive biases.

■ *CONCLUSION - PERSONAL EVEREST*

A 'Personal Everest' is a journey with a purpose. ***"But at least learn your inability... and ask the remedy for it. Learn of those who have been bound like you... These are people who know the way which you would follow, and who are cured of an ill of which you would be cured. Follow the way by which they began..."***

Blaise Pascal - Pascals Wager (10)

A Personal Everest is a journey with a purpose. It is a self-defined expedition of personal development, with support and guidance from peers and the Author, and analysis by AI.

SCOTOMAVILLE is an unconventional and effective self-help model and platform with a convincing challenge: We can change our life experiences by gaming our own handicaps, strengthening alliances, challenging our shortcomings and changing our false beliefs by taking on our Personal Everest.

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(1) https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/33711676/

(2) https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC8402266/

(3) https://www.ted.com/talks/kathryn_schulz_on_being_wrong/transcript

(4) https://www.amazon.co.uk/Yossi-Yassour/e/B08XJNFCNK/

(5) https://www.humanetech.com/who-we-are#team

(6) https://www.wired.com/video/watch/yuval-harari-tristan-harris-humans-get-hacked

(7) https://intelligentnetware.com

(8) https://scotomaville.com/digital-locations

(9) https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/W._H._Murray

(10) https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Pascal%27s_wager



2.01 PERSISTENCE

EXPEDITION

"Persistence: a personality trait demonstrated by firm or obstinate continuance in a course of action in spite of difficulty or opposition"



Purgatory Ski Resort, Colorado

Welcome back to SCOTOMAVILLE. What a fabulous Episode this will be on sticking with and not quitting a 'journey with a purpose.'

I'm so excited. Angelina and I will finally get a dream we've been working on a long time. And yet, there is nothing like an expedition to expose flaws in our character. Here we go.

We've ordered stuff from Amazon. We're packing it in the truck. After four prior attempts (this will be number five), it is finally time to purchase our Airstream. It's in Albuquerque, New Mexico. It's the only one like it in the United States. Airstream built this Globetrotter the week of the COVID-19 shutdown. It's exactly what we want for the price we can afford. Our four bankers assure us that our scores are good. Our financing is set, and so we are off to Albuquerque.

I'm wondering why it is going so smoothly? I've been on a few expeditions. They're never this smooth.

BUTTERFLIES FOR LUNCH

We're in Baker City, Oregon, headed to Albuquerque, NM. We're on our first lunch break, and we have a butterfly. I mean, Angelina is taking a video of a butterfly flying overhead.



I have a story to share. During my 2005 Trans-Am, I met Glen Douglas in Fargo, North Dakota. He knew all about the butterflies. Yeah, the butterflies that seemed to have fun with me.

In 2005, I flew to Seattle to spend time with my son. I started pedaling east from Bellingham, Washington, over the Cascade Mountains. Somewhere in the middle of Idaho, butterflies began flying with me. No, not just across my path. They would come out from the fields and fly alongside me in one of four quadrants. They flew just out of reach in those four sectors. I thought this weird.

(see medicine wheel quadrants at right)

I cycled across Montana. At least a couple of times, Sheriff and Police and other law enforcement had said to me, "you be a little careful where you're staying. The tribes have some tensions on your route. We've got a couple of missing cyclists, and we don't want you to fall into any trouble. So you watch yourself. Take care that you're under a light when you camp."

I Listened to Stay Safe

One morning, a weather front had just gone through, and it was cold. I was wet as I cycled into Fargo, North Dakota. Angelina had mailed a complimentary breakfast coupon to me, so I went to McDonald's for a hot breakfast. I looked around, surprised that it was full of senior citizens. I mean, there was NO WHERE to sit except at a table with an Indian - and you remember I was supposed to keep my distance - but I thought; 'there are plenty of witnesses - it's broad daylight, come on Daniel.'

I got my meal at the counter, and I heard the Indian fellow bark, "hey... I need to talk to you!"

I noticed people began looking at me. I turned around to see the Indian gentleman sitting at the table pointing at me. "I need to talk to you," he said. I thought, 'this is interesting.'

I sat down at the table and started eating. I focused on what Glen was wearing. He looked like a Walmart greeter. His hat had metallic pins around the brim. His shirt had all kinds of pins and medallions, and ribbons. I caught my scotoma as I recognized his battle medallions.

I fumbled a question... "Who are you?"

He said, "I'm Glen Douglas ." So I dug into his story a little bit. You might know the movie with Nicholas Cage called Windtalkers. Glen was one of the original Windtalkers from the Korean War. As we sat, I learned he was the oldest living, most decorated, Native American Army Intelligence Officer. Glen had a Silver Star and many fascinating life experiences.

I remember struggling to take it all in and find meaning in our meeting.

(note: I wanted to quickly find a pattern in order to assign meaning. All three are core cognitive biases)

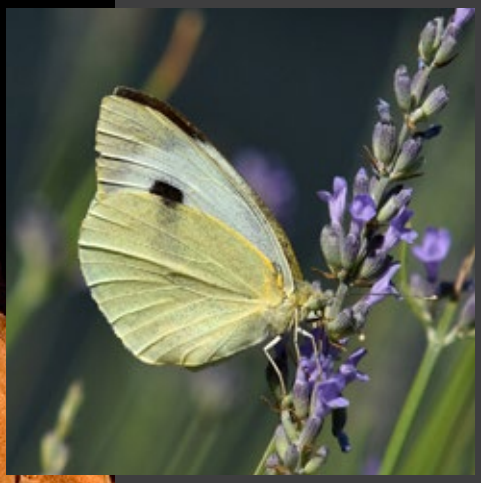
Then, quite abruptly, in the middle of the conversation, I asked, "why do you have to talk to me?" He laid the paper he was looking at down on the table. Pointing to a picture of me, he asked, "is that you?"

"Yeah," I said. "And that's you?"

(on the opposite side of the paper)







Glen Douglas

a Lakes-Okanagan Indian, Silver Star Recipient, Special Forces Intelligence Analyst in World War II, the Korean War and the Vietnam War. Douglas served as chairman of the VA Native American Advisory Council and was a respected source of expertise on PTSD issues for Native American combat veterans.







KARE 5 News, Minneapolis MN:
Onus Probandi

So we are sitting together, and he's reading a newspaper with both of us in it.

Glen wanted to know what I was doing. So I shared a little bit on cycling across America, Angelina's head injury from a car wreck, and I was trying to get a message out about not going alone, about perseverance and overcoming challenges, loss, and hardships...

KARE 5 NEWS CLIP

News Anchor: *"On the same day, Lance Armstrong rode into Paris for the final time a cyclist from Seattle rode into the twin cities for the first time. Daniel Comp is traveling cross country on his bike to raise awareness for women in business. The long-time cyclist got the idea after his wife was injured in a bad car crash. She was an entrepreneur, and he's riding in honor of her."*

Daniel: *"Through peer support and mentoring, they all sort of network together, share their business ideas, and help each other in business. Incredible things are coming out of it. We're trying to bring it out of Texas and up across the Northern U.S.."*

News Anchor: *"Comp started his journey in Seattle just after Father's Day. He figures if he travels 80 to 100 miles a day, he'll reach the east coast by the end of August."*

"Butterflies? They know... Your mission. You're changing and you're helping people. The butterflies are there so you don't quit... and the horses too!"

Glen Douglas



We stopped for lunch in Baker City, Oregon. Angelina is filming a persistent butterfly. 15 years ago, Glen said the butterflies were there so we wouldn't quit. Quit? We're going to pick up our Airstream... right?

TALKING WITH GLEN

*I said, "Oh!... Glen, you're an Indian!" I remember that loud and awkward blurt. I get goosebumps because it was an obvious, but inappropriate statement to make out loud. "**You're an Indian!**" I said excitedly. **What's with the butterflies?** I asked.*

In a hushed and calmly wise tone Glen said, "Oh... the butterflies. They know."

Puzzled, I asked; "They know? They know what?"

"Your mission," Glen said.

I was dumbfounded. "My mission?" I asked.

Glen said, "you're changing, and you're helping people. The butterflies are there, so you don't quit - and the horses too."

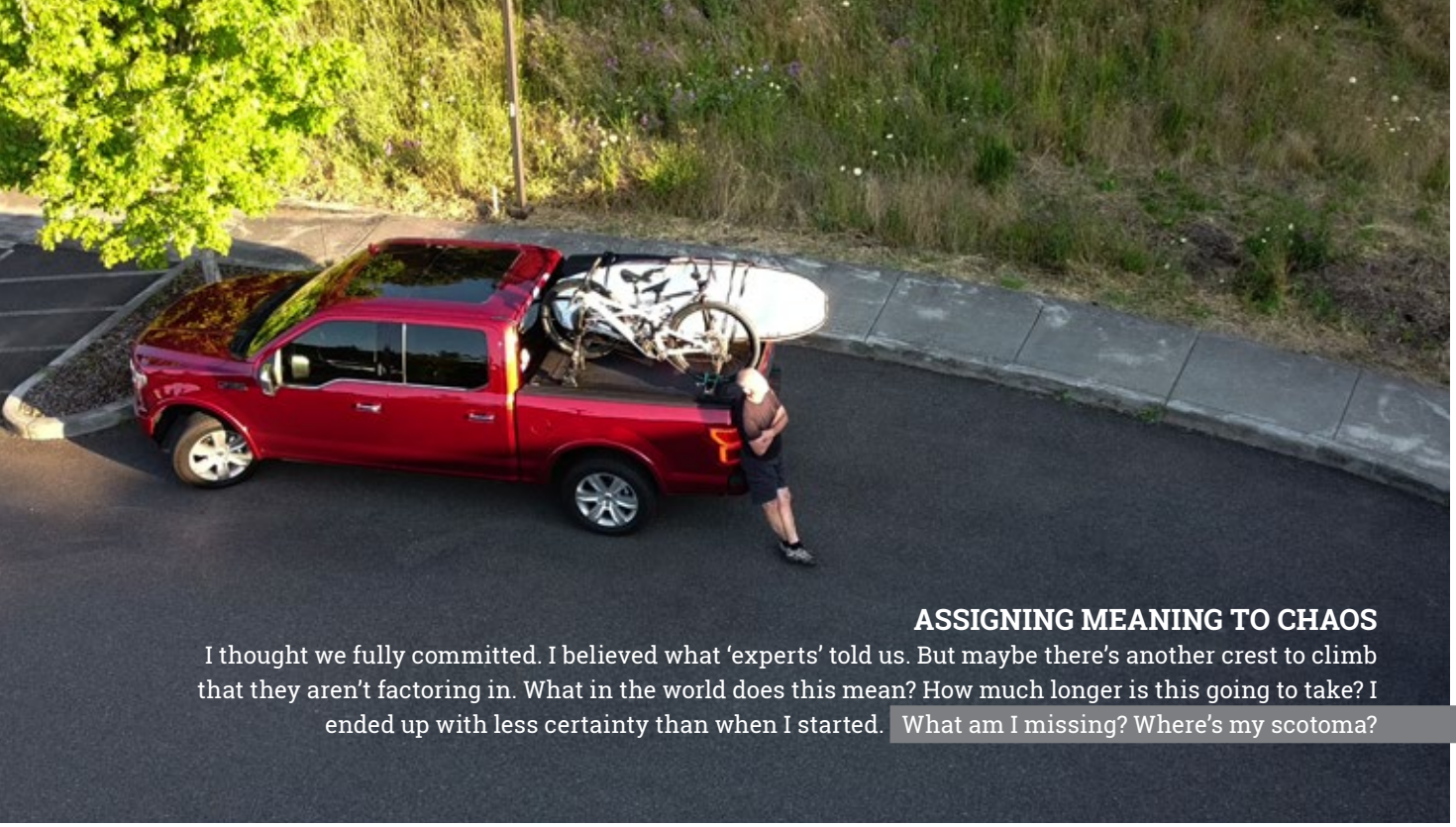
I have goosebumps recalling this because I had not told anyone, even Angelina, about the horses. Up to that point of my ride across America, I had had three small pelotons run with me. I thought it weird.

Apparently, it's not uncommon. Horses ran in the Tour de France once, but I found it pretty unusual to be in the middle of the Dakotas with have wild horses pacing me.

BUTTERFLIES SAVED ME

It turns out that butterflies saved my life on that expedition. Glen said according to Native American folklore the butterflies were there to encourage and protect me. The earlier protection, as I crossed Montana, was obvious to me.

I had later met with Clint Hackney with one of the tribal (SPIPA) groups in the Pacific Northwest. He shared the meaning of the Native Medicine Wheel. The four quadrants of the wheel have spiritual significance. Butterflies represent 'new birth.'



ASSIGNING MEANING TO CHAOS

I thought we fully committed. I believed what 'experts' told us. But maybe there's another crest to climb that they aren't factoring in. What in the world does this mean? How much longer is this going to take? I ended up with less certainty than when I started. What am I missing? Where's my scotoma?

I sat on that story for decades.

We're now headed to Albuquerque with a butterfly reminding us NOT to QUIT.

THEN PROVIDENCE MOVES

Angelina and I have been trying to make a difference for others for a couple of decades now. It's been a long, long journey. So what does commitment mean for a couple?

Once we fully commit, and can't turn back, then things occur that we would never have expected. People, resources, and events turn up in the most wonderful ways.

I finished the first Trans-America believing that the butterfly story would be valuable at the right time. I had no idea when, but post-pandemic, it's a different world now. We can't do things the way we used to. We're not just aware of COVID; we have had to change habits by paying attention to small things a lot more than before.

BREAKING OLD HABITS

We continued our trip from Salt Lake City to Grand Junction. On day two, I got on the elevator, and at the last second, as the doors were

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"but when I said that nothing had been done I erred in one important matter. We had definitely committed ourselves and were halfway out of our ruts. We had put down our passage money— booked a sailing to Bombay. This may sound too simple, but is great in consequence. **Until one is committed, there is hesitancy, the chance to draw back, always ineffectiveness.** Concerning all acts of initiative (and creation), there is one elementary truth, the ignorance of which kills countless ideas and splendid plans: that **the moment one definitely commits oneself, then Providence moves too.** All sorts of things occur to help one that would never otherwise have occurred. A whole stream of events issues from the decision, raising in one's favour all manner of unforeseen incidents and meetings and material assistance, which no man could have dreamt would have come his way.

W. H. Murray
The Scottish Himalayan Expedition (1951)

closing, a man without a mask stuck his hand between the closing doors and jumped on the elevator with me. Boy, did I give him a little stare! You don't shove your hand in the door to get on the elevator when people are already on it. I had to insist that the family of seven could not ride the elevator with me.

FORMING NEW HABITS

W. H. Murray wrote,

"once you fully commit then providence moves."

We are all constantly resisted, opposed, and frustrated. Enduring hardship by fasting is not commitment!

We have to be fully ***COMMITTED,*** *not simply* ***CORNERED.***



THERE'S MORE TO LEARN

We're learning more about financing a 'recreational vehicle' than the loan people. Credit reports are not real-time. They may be precise, but they're hardly accurate.

It seems we have to 'wrestle' for what we want. We can't just wait for it to happen. We have to initiate and fully commit before Providence moves.

LEARNING TOGETHER

When you're on a climbing expedition, you rope into each other. You get to experience some of the stumbles of everyone else. When you're in a marriage or partnership, you get to learn together.

It's s been five days now. I thought we were fully committed. We were supposedly pre-approved, but we won't be leaving Albuquerque with our Airstream. Instead, an underwriter working from home has decided COVID demands higher financial standards. This judgment, once again, fits the false conclusion loaded on my hillbilly truck that; '***I'm not included. I'm not one of them***.'

Remember Second-hand Lions; "everybody needs something to believe in - even if it's not true?" People fib by telling 'stories' when their beliefs are questioned. They fill in the 'questionable gaps' as if believing someone else's narrative lets them off the hook.

(blatant in media and news today)

WE BELIEVED ENTHUSIASM

We shouldn't have acted on what well-meaning bankers said as fact. Don't do what we did - mistake enthusiasm for truth - to drive across the country, pre-qualified to buy our Airstream. Unfortunately, people share 'stories' as facts.

That's a hard lesson. It seems you can't get up Mount Everest on a bad weather day - no matter how much you plan, prepare and practice.

We have lessons yet to be learned in this life with curves.

DON'T QUIT ANYWAY

Persistence *- a firm or obstinate continuance in a course of action in spite of difficulty or opposition. Don't quit. W.H. Murray and butterflies say so.*



WATCH

https://youtu.be/Qph3VJc-H64

*I think it's time to advance from **I Do, You Watch**, toward **We Do, We Watch**.*

*This worksheet will test if you are **fully committed** or **simply cornered**. If the thought of starting your own channel, series and book frightens then we are on target. You remember that you can't steer a bicycle until it's rolling, right? Same with transformation. It takes faith, hope and fact to triangulate commitment.*

Watch the very first video I shot four years ago.

https://youtu.be/I2FhUIQFDkc

Follow in the way I began.

List ideas and insights you've made thus far by applying Scotomavile to challenges and puzzles. Shoot video clips for setbacks that surface. Trust me; the 'Murphes' will come. Assemble the clips into the first episode of your 'journey with a purpose'.

DISCUSS

It's time to share your first episode rough-cut or chapter draft with other Scotomaville Explorers, Mountaineers, Guides and Leaders. Discuss this Episode, and post your work.

Please help me find a fable or parable about having perseverance.

Certainly, Daniel!
The domain pertinent to this question involves storytelling and parables, and the suitable references here would include Aesop and the Grimms Brothers.

A classic fable that epitomizes the value of perseverance is "The Tortoise and the Hare" by Aesop. This timeless tale serves as an allegory for steady persistence and determination.

The story goes as follows:

The hare, confident in his innate speed, boasts about how fast he is and challenges the tortoise, who is known for his slow pace, to a race. The tortoise accepts the challenge, and they agree upon the terms of the race.

Once the race begins, the hare dashes ahead, so sure of his victory that he decides to take a nap halfway through. The tortoise, although slow, continues to plod along at a consistent pace. He doesn't falter or lose hope, even when the finish line seems impossibly far away.

Eventually, the hare awakens, only to find that the tortoise is nearing the finish line. In a panic, the hare tries to catch up, but it's too late. The tortoise, with his slow and steady perseverance, wins the race.

The moral of the story, which aligns with your philosophy of self-mastery and personal growth, is that perseverance and consistency can lead to success, even when facing seemingly insurmountable odds. This fable teaches us not to be overconfident in our abilities and instead to focus on our journey with unwavering determination.

As Jim Rohn, one of the personal development experts from your minyan, once said, ***"Success is neither magical nor mysterious. Success is the natural consequence of consistently applying basic fundamentals."*** *The tortoise's victory in this fable beautifully illustrates this wisdom.*



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